

Jonathan Blackburn

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In 2015, Blackburn formed Trust in Hope Recovery House, a live-in program that assists recovering addicts as they transition into leading productive, healthy lives. Many residents have been addicts since they were kids, compelled by a genetic predisposition for addiction. Trust in Hope inspired Blackburn's next endeavor.

He started iMed because he realized existing drug tests weren't accurately screening for exotic narcotics being used in South Africa but not commonly found in other parts of the world. Due to testing flaws, people were being falsely accused of using drugs that lead to devastating consequences. Dire fallout resulted in the loss of jobs, custody of children, and in some cases even their freedom. The mistakes conducted during these drug tests were destroying families, and Blackburn was determined to change that.

Founded in 2014, iMed Distributors has grown into South Africa's premium, rapid diagnostic drug-testing supplier. Blackburn also created the country's first privately owned forensic toxicology laboratory.

In the year 2019 the world was hit by a global pandemic and having few laboratories in South Africa performing PCR covid-19 tests thus putting a huge strain on our public health system Blackburn saw it wise to start a PCR molecular laboratory to help fight and combat the pandemic.

In a very short space Blackburn has managed to grow iMED into a brand that is known both nationally and internationally. A brand that is spoken highly of in terms of service and quality. With iMED growing rapidly there had to be an addition and that was iMED Cape Town branch, with iMED Distributors, iMED Laboratories, iMED Pharmaceuticals and iMED Cape Town all falling under the iMED Medical Group umbrella headquartered in Pretoria.

It is safe to say that an element of social responsibility is threaded throughout Jonathan Blackburn's entrepreneurial pursuits. He believes in giving back just as much as he believes in striving for success and that has not been proven otherwise.

Experience

iMED Medical Group

SEPT 2015 - PRESENT

Director

Laboratories (Pty) Ltd: Forensic toxicology and molecular biology

Distributors (Pty) Ltd: Global rapid diagnostics and equipment

Pharmaceuticals (Pty) Ltd: Rapid analysis test kit assembling

Trust In Hope Recovery Home

2014

Recovery Director

Elite Technologies

JAN 2006

Managing director AV Sales and Design

Education

Essential DNA Sequencing DNAbiotec

Empowering the delegate with all the necessary theoretical and practical knowledge to use the tool of DNA sequencing to its fullest potential which includes but not limited to analysis of sequence data, troubleshoot of automated sequencing results,

automated sequencing.

Certified Quality Management and Quality Assurance Manager

Understanding of what management style best serves the organisation. Managing dynamics, conflicts and motivations. Knowledge of how to support direct reports.

ISO 9001:2005 Internal Auditor

Ability to evaluate effectiveness and identify opportunities for improvement.

Assess conformity and be able to assess the organizations overall performance.

ISO 9001: 2015 QMS Implementation and auditing practices

Empowering the knowledge on how to implement new changes practically. The identification of which management tools need to be used in align with the new requirements and structure of management system standards.

EU Medical device regulatory affairs explained simply

Medical devices regulation training

Basics of distribution and logistics

Improving the logistics within a company and channel design of inventory.

Skills

Management skills, strategic decision-making, strong written and verbal communication skills, tech savvy, delegation, strong leadership, critical and analytical thinking, result orientated, business strategy. Maintaining and calibrating technical equipment, quality assurance and control, tech and resource savvy, new business and service development, research, project management, technical asset management, electronic data management, Health innovation, Resource delegation and utilization, sound entrepreneurial leadership and management competencies, strategic planning and detail oriented, business networking, Quality Management Systems (ISO 17025: 2017 and ISO 9001:2015), internal auditing.

Recommendations

Jason Ioakim

Director and Financial Planner, Argo Financial

Jonathan Blackburn was referred to me by another client over 6 years ago and I had no idea how much I'd learn from this relationship. I have seen him personally grow into such an entrepreneurial genius. His will to improve other people's lives whether his clients or his staff has always been such a driving factor in his businesses. He lives to make a difference. It is inspiring. There is always an opportunity and if you wanted to sit down with someone who has been on the brink and then turned it around I'd go have a coffee with him you'll not regret it.

William Haarhoff CA(SA)

CEO and Founder: DoughGetters Group, DoughGetters Accounting

I have had the privilege of working with Jonathan for the last 3 years providing bookkeeping, accounting and tax compliance support to one of his companies. I continue to stand amazed at the manner in which Jono strives towards highest quality customer service, entrepreneurial flair and an absolute "can-do" attitude. Jono is a problem solver, go-getter of note and he cares deeply for people.

Francois de Kock

Commercial Property Broker, Abacus DIVISIONS

Jonathan is a detail oriented, outcomes focused businessman with client centered outlook. He gets the job done no matter the scope of the project.

Charlene Jooste

Owner, Tasting Matters - Special Events & Catering

Ethics & sincerity is the phrases that come to mind when I think about Jono. He has been a source of inspiration to me the past year. Above all his customer service is outstanding. Jono is detailed orientated and only satisfied with the best! He also never stops reaching out to people. It is always a privilege doing business with him! I definitely recommend him and his expertise.

Ronny Gell

Director, AGM Inc

Jonathan and his team at Elite Technologies have always delivered great service with an all encompassing technical understanding. I will definitely recommend them.

Noel Pastor

Business Manager, Sublime Innovative Technology

Jonathan has a fantastic work ethic and runs his company extremely well, with honesty and fairness being his strong points. He is extremely diligent and has a keen eye for detail. He is consistently involved in all aspects of the business which is a great contributing factor to its success.

Montague N. Sualez

Equine Specialist Internist, Winelands Equine Vet

Jonathan and his team performed an audio installation at our premises. Enjoyed working with them, they offered prompt and reliable service. I would certainly use Jonathan and the company again.

Derick Haywood

Senior Account Manager & Product Specialist, Linkqage

Since meeting Jonathan 3 years ago I have been amazed by his knowledge and his ethical professionalism. He is a true example of a real business person who treats his customers and suppliers equally good.

Wendy Kraus

Owner, Minuteman Press

Jono is always ready to go that extra mile to find the right solution for your dream cinema room or upgraded board room. He has the expertise to find the best solution for you. All the high tech gadgets are just mind boggling. Thanks Jono.
